

GEDYON — THE 45-WEEK BUILD

Mon Sep 7, 2026 – Sun Jul 18, 2027 · Elias Gedyon · Boulder, CO · Mission: 2028 Olympic Trials. This macrocycle starts from CURRENT fitness (165 lb, effective ~VDOT mid-40s) and earns its way up. (Sep 3–6 is the ramp-in — follow the 12-day block sheet, then start Week 1 here.)

THE SIX PHASES

PHASE	WEEKS	DATES	WHAT IT DOES	VOLUME
P1 · REBUILD	Wk 1–6	Sep 7 – Oct 18	Aerobic base + durability at honest paces. Weight work is here: 1 lb/wk. Hills = strength.	24→32 mi
P2 · BASE	Wk 7–14	Oct 19 – Dec 13	Volume climbs, threshold 1000s become weekly bread. First 5k time trial (wk 10) resets VDOT with real evidence.	32→40 mi
P3 · BUILD	Wk 15–22	Dec 14 – Feb 7	VO2 work enters (Wed hills become alternating hills/200s). Indoor race opportunities — every race feeds the engine number.	40→46 mi
P4 · THRESHOLD	Wk 23–30	Feb 8 – Apr 4	Norwegian double-threshold weeks (the doubles you asked about live HERE, earned). Peak volume. Outdoor season opens.	46→52 mi
P5 · SHARPEN	Wk 31–38	Apr 5 – May 30	Race-specific: mile/1500 pace work, tune-up races every 2–3 weeks. Volume holds, intensity peaks.	~50 mi
P6 · RACE	Wk 39–45	May 31 – Jul 18	Championship season. Taper cycles around goal races. Everything you built gets spent on purpose.	38→45 mi

THE PACE LADDER — GATED, NOT DATED

The engine of this plan: **every block is 3 weeks of building, then a deload week that ENDS with a fresh-legs tempo test** — 20 minutes at the next tier's pace, under the HR cap. Pass and the whole pace card moves up for the next block; fail and you keep building at the current tier and retest in 4 weeks, having lost nothing. Races and time trials count as tests too (they outrank them). Week numbers are the EARLIEST a tier may start — the plan never asks for a pace you haven't proven.

TIER	EARLIEST	PACES	GATE TO ADVANCE
T1	now	Easy 9:30–10:15 · Tempo 7:35–7:50 · 1000s 7:38–7:53	Gate to T2: 20min @ 7:25–7:30 under HR 165 (green day)
T2	wk 5+	Easy 9:15–10:00 · Tempo 7:20–7:35 · 1000s 7:25–7:40	Gate to T3: 5k time trial ≤ 22:30 (wk 10) or equivalent race
T3	wk 11+	Easy 9:00–9:45 · Tempo 7:05–7:20 · 1000s 7:10–7:25 · 200s @ 40–42s	Gate to T4: 5k ≤ 21:15 or 20min tempo @ 6:55 under cap
T4	wk 19+	Easy 8:45–9:30 · Tempo 6:55–7:10 · 1000s 6:58–7:12	Gate to T5: race result (indoor mile/3k) confirming VDOT +2
T5	wk 27+	Easy 8:30–9:15 · Tempo 6:45–7:00 · 1000s 6:48–7:02 · race-pace 400s	Gate to T6: outdoor race, season opener
T6	wk 35+	Easy 8:30–9:15 · Tempo 6:40–6:55 · full race-specific menu	Championship tier — race results drive everything

STANDING RULES — ALL 45 WEEKS

Weekly rhythm: Mon easy double + core · Tue quality (threshold) · Wed hills/speed + easy · Thu easy double + core · Fri quality (fartlek or threshold, alternating) · Sat long run · Sun active recovery.

The 4-week engine: build · build · build · deload+TEST. Every 4th week (marked D) drops volume –30% and cuts reps in half — then Friday, on fresh legs, you run the 20-min tempo test at the next tier's pace. Deloads are where adaptation happens AND where progress gets proven — never skip one to "stay on pace."

WHOOP gates every day: Green = as written. Yellow = one quality max, HR-capped, doubles lose their PM. Red = easy or rest, workout moves to next green day. (The app enforces this automatically.)

Effort beats pace, always. Every quality session carries an HR cap. Breaking the cap to hit a pace is a failed session, not a brave one.

Weight: 165 → ~150 by week 30, then HOLD through race season. ~0.7 lb/wk in P1–P3, fueled quality days always. Never cut on a quality or long day.

Doubles with two quality sessions exist only in P4+, only on green days, only after T4 paces are unlocked. Until then every double is easy AM + easy PM.

THE 45 WEEKS

Rhythm: 3 build weeks, then D = deload week ending in the Friday tempo test · TT/RACE weeks shaded gold · T* = pace tier IF its gate has been passed (otherwise stay on the tier you own). Mileage is the green-week target — yellow/red days reduce it and that is correct, not a miss.

P1 REBUILD	P2 BASE	P3 BUILD	P4 THRESHOLD	P5 SHARPEN	P6 RACE	DELOAD+TEST	RACE / TT
WK	DATES	PH	MI	TIER	KEY SESSIONS & NOTES		
1	Sep 7–Sep 13	P1	24	T1	Tue 4×1000m · Wed 8–10×80m hills · Fri 20–25min tempo or fartlek · Sat long 6–7 mi.		
2	Sep 14–Sep 20	P1	26	T1	Tue 4×1000m · Wed 8–10×80m hills · Fri 20–25min tempo or fartlek · Sat long 6–7 mi.		
3	Sep 21–Sep 27	P1	27	T1	Tue 5×1000m · Wed 8–10×80m hills · Fri 20–25min tempo or fartlek · Sat long 7–8 mi.		
4 D	Sep 28–Oct 4	P1	20	T1	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.		
5	Oct 5–Oct 11	P1	30	T2*	Tue 6×1000m · Wed 8–10×80m hills · Fri 20–25min tempo or fartlek · Sat long 7–8 mi.		
6	Oct 12–Oct 18	P1	32	T2*	Tue 6×1000m · Wed 8–10×80m hills · Fri 20–25min tempo or fartlek · Sat long 8–9 mi.		
7	Oct 19–Oct 25	P2	32	T2*	Tue 5×1000m · Wed 10–12×80m hills · Fri alternating fartlek / 20–30min tempo · Sat long 9–11 mi with steady finish.		
8 D	Oct 26–Nov 1	P2	23	T2*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.		
9	Nov 2–Nov 8	P2	34	T2*	Tue 6×1000m · Wed 10–12×80m hills · Fri alternating fartlek / 20–30min tempo · Sat long 9–11 mi with steady finish.		
10	Nov 9–Nov 15	P2	35	T2*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, 5K TIME TRIAL. Long run easy or moved after race.		
11	Nov 16–Nov 22	P2	37	T3*	Tue 7×1000m · Wed 10–12×80m hills · Fri alternating fartlek / 20–30min tempo · Sat long 9–11 mi with steady finish.		
12 D	Nov 23–Nov 29	P2	26	T3*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.		
13	Nov 30–Dec 6	P2	39	T3*	Tue 8×1000m · Wed 10–12×80m hills · Fri alternating fartlek / 20–30min tempo · Sat long 9–11 mi with steady finish.		
14	Dec 7–Dec 13	P2	40	T3*	Tue 8×1000m · Wed 10–12×80m hills · Fri alternating fartlek / 20–30min tempo · Sat long 9–11 mi with steady finish.		
15	Dec 14–Dec 20	P3	40	T3*	Tue 6–8×1000m · Wed alternate hills / 8–10×200m @ T3 speed · Fri fartlek w/ gear-change surges · Sat long 11–13 mi, last 2 steady.		
16 D	Dec 21–Dec 27	P3	29	T3*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.		
17	Dec 28–Jan 3	P3	42	T3*	Tue 6–8×1000m · Wed alternate hills / 8–10×200m @ T3 speed · Fri fartlek w/ gear-change surges · Sat long 11–13 mi, last 2 steady.		
18	Jan 4–Jan 10	P3	43	T3*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, Indoor opener (3k or mile). Long run easy or moved after race.		
19	Jan 11–Jan 17	P3	43	T4*	Tue 6–8×1000m · Wed alternate hills / 8–10×200m @ T3 speed · Fri fartlek w/ gear-change surges · Sat long 11–13 mi, last 2 steady.		
20 D	Jan 18–Jan 24	P3	31	T4*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.		

WK	DATES	PH	MI	TIER	KEY SESSIONS & NOTES
21	Jan 25–Jan 31	P3	45	T4*	Tue 6–8×1000m · Wed alternate hills / 8–10×200m @ T3 speed · Fri fartlek w/ gear-change surges · Sat long 11–13 mi, last 2 steady.
22	Feb 1–Feb 7	P3	46	T4*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, Indoor race #2. Long run easy or moved after race.
23	Feb 8–Feb 14	P4	46	T4*	DOUBLE-THRESHOLD (green days only): Tue AM 5×1000m + PM 4×1000m sub-threshold · Wed hills · Fri tempo 25–30min · Sat long 12–14 mi.
24 D	Feb 15–Feb 21	P4	33	T4*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.
25	Feb 22–Feb 28	P4	48	T4*	DOUBLE-THRESHOLD (green days only): Tue AM 5×1000m + PM 4×1000m sub-threshold · Wed hills · Fri tempo 25–30min · Sat long 12–14 mi.
26	Mar 1–Mar 7	P4	49	T4*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, 2-mile time trial or indoor championship race. Long run easy or moved after race.
27	Mar 8–Mar 14	P4	49	T5*	DOUBLE-THRESHOLD (green days only): Tue AM 5×1000m + PM 4×1000m sub-threshold · Wed hills · Fri tempo 25–30min · Sat long 12–14 mi.
28 D	Mar 15–Mar 21	P4	35	T5*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.
29	Mar 22–Mar 28	P4	51	T5*	DOUBLE-THRESHOLD (green days only): Tue AM 5×1000m + PM 4×1000m sub-threshold · Wed hills · Fri tempo 25–30min · Sat long 12–14 mi.
30	Mar 29–Apr 4	P4	52	T5*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, Outdoor season opener (T5 gate). Long run easy or moved after race.
31	Apr 5–Apr 11	P5	48	T5*	Tue 1000s @ T5 · Wed 300s/400s at 1500-race pace · Fri tempo or pre-race · Sat long 10–12 mi easy. Races every 2–3 wks.
32 D	Apr 12–Apr 18	P5	34	T5*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.
33	Apr 19–Apr 25	P5	49	T5*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, Tune-up race (1500/5k). Long run easy or moved after race.
34	Apr 26–May 2	P5	50	T5*	Tue 1000s @ T5 · Wed 300s/400s at 1500-race pace · Fri tempo or pre-race · Sat long 10–12 mi easy. Races every 2–3 wks.
35	May 3–May 9	P5	50	T6*	Tue 1000s @ T5 · Wed 300s/400s at 1500-race pace · Fri tempo or pre-race · Sat long 10–12 mi easy. Races every 2–3 wks.
36 D	May 10–May 16	P5	36	T6*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, Tune-up race. Long run easy or moved after race.
37	May 17–May 23	P5	51	T6*	Tue 1000s @ T5 · Wed 300s/400s at 1500-race pace · Fri tempo or pre-race · Sat long 10–12 mi easy. Races every 2–3 wks.
38	May 24–May 30	P5	52	T6*	Tue 1000s @ T5 · Wed 300s/400s at 1500-race pace · Fri tempo or pre-race · Sat long 10–12 mi easy. Races every 2–3 wks.
39	May 31–Jun 6	P6	46	T6*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, First championship-season race. Long run easy or moved after race.
40 D	Jun 7–Jun 13	P6	31	T6*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.
41	Jun 14–Jun 20	P6	43	T6*	Race-week pattern: Tue sharp 600s/400s (low volume) · Wed strides only · Fri shakeout · race Sat/Sun · recover, repeat.
42	Jun 21–Jun 27	P6	42	T6*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, Goal race #1. Long run easy or moved after race.

WK	DATES	PH	MI	TIER	KEY SESSIONS & NOTES
43	Jun 28–Jul 4	P6	41	T6*	Race-week pattern: Tue sharp 600s/400s (low volume) · Wed strides only · Fri shakeout · race Sat/Sun · recover, repeat.
44 D	Jul 5–Jul 11	P6	28	T6*	DELOAD + TEST: Tue 1000s at 50%% reps · easy days · Fri TEMPO TEST on fresh legs: 20min at the NEXT tier's pace, under the HR cap (green day; yellow = push test to Sat, red = skip, retest next block) · Sat long –30%%.
45	Jul 12–Jul 18	P6	38	T6*	Race/TT week: Tue light 1000s (60%), Fri pre-race shakeout + strides, Season finale / goal race #2. Long run easy or moved after race.

HOW TO USE THIS

Print the current 2 weeks from the app (PRINT MONTH) for daily detail; this document is the map, the app is the turn-by-turn. They run the same engine.

When a gate is passed, tell KODA (or approve the changeset in the COACH REVIEW queue) — every pace in the app moves up together, and this sheet's next tier becomes active.

When life breaks a week, resume where the calendar says, not where you left off. The gap protocol in the app re-replaces you automatically. Never stack missed quality.

Race weeks beat plan weeks. Real results are worth more than any workout — if a race conflicts with a listed session, race, then give it 48h of easy.

The only unbreakable rule: 45 weeks of showing up at honest effort beats 15 weeks of heroics followed by injury. Every rule above exists to serve this one.